

Word family: ****incredible / incredibly / incredibility / incredulous / incredulously****

****Base word:**** incredible

****Adverb:**** incredibly

****Related noun:**** incredibility

****Related adjective:**** incredulous

****Related adverb:**** incredulously

****Useful constructions/extensions:**** incredible story, incredible claim, incredible achievement, incredible view, incredibly strong, incredibly difficult, absolutely incredible, almost incredible, incredulous look, stare incredulously

****Part of speech:**** adjective (形容詞) / adverb (副詞) / related adjective and noun forms (相關形容詞及名詞)

Your passage contains:

> “Although she is quite small and physically frail, she has an ****incredibly strong spirit****.”

Here, ****incredibly**** means:

****to an extremely high degree; remarkably.****

Meaning in this passage

In:

> ****incredibly strong spirit****

****incredibly**** is being used as an ****intensifier****.

It strengthens:

> ****strong****

So the sentence means that your grandmother's inner strength is:

* extremely strong;

* remarkable;

* unusually impressive.

It does ****not**** mean:

> “her spirit is literally impossible to believe.”

****Meaning:**** Extremely; to a remarkably high degree.

****繁體中文：** ****極其；非常；強烈到令人印象深刻的程度****

****中文翻譯：** ******

> “She has an incredibly strong spirit.”

「她有著****極其堅強 / 非常堅韌的精神****。」

So:

****incredibly strong = 極其強大 / 非常堅強****

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****incredible = very difficult to believe (難以置信的) — 難以相信；不可思議****

This is the original/core meaning.

****Meaning:**** So surprising, unusual, or unlikely that it is difficult to believe.

Practice 1

> “He told an ****incredible story****.”

「他講了一個****難以置信的故事****。」

Practice 2

> “The claim sounds incredible.”

「這個說法聽起來****令人難以相信****。」

****incredible = 事情極不尋常、極不可能或極令人驚訝，因此難以相信****

2. ****incredible claim/story/report (難以相信的說法) — 不可思議；可信度低****

Practice 3

> “That is an ****incredible claim**** without evidence.”

「在沒有證據的情況下，那是一個**難以置信的說法**。」

Practice 4

> “The report sounded almost incredible.”

「那份報告聽起來幾乎**令人無法相信**。」

****incredible = 某項陳述 / 故事超出正常預期，因此讓人懷疑其真實性****

3. ****incredible = amazing / extremely impressive (驚人的) — 驚人；非常出色****

A major modern sense.

****Meaning:**** Extremely good, impressive, beautiful, skillful, or remarkable.

Practice 5

> “She gave an ****incredible performance****.”

「她有一場****極為精彩 / 驚人的表現****。」

Practice 6

> “The view was incredible.”

「景色****美得驚人 / 非常壯觀****。」

****incredible = 好、漂亮、出色或 impressive 到令人驚嘆的程度****

This is very common in modern informal English.

4. ****incredible achievement/result (驚人成就 / 結果) — 非凡；了不起****

Practice 7

> “Winning the competition was an ****incredible achievement****.”

「贏得比賽是一項****了不起的成就****。」

Practice 8

> “The team achieved incredible results.”

「團隊取得了**非常驚人的成果**。」

incredible = 成就 / 結果的程度遠超一般預期

5. **incredible person/talent (非常厲害的人 / 才能) — 出色 ; 令人佩服**

Practice 9

> “She is an **incredible teacher**.”

「她是一位**非常出色的老師**。」

Practice 10

> “He has incredible talent.”

「他有**驚人的才能**。」

incredible = 人或能力表現極其出色、令人印象深刻

6. **incredible = extraordinary in scale/degree (驚人的程度) — 極大 ; 非常**

A broader degree sense.

Practice 11

> “They spent an **incredible amount of money**.”

「他們花了**驚人的一大筆錢**。」

Practice 12

> “The project required an incredible amount of work.”

「這個項目需要**極大量的工作**。」

incredible = 數量、程度或規模大得異乎尋常

7. **incredibly = extremely (極其；非常) — 極度；非常**

This is the exact family form used in your passage.

Practice 13 — Original

> “She has an **incredibly strong spirit**.”

「她有著**極其堅強的精神**。」

Practice 14

> “The test was **incredibly difficult**.”

「測驗**非常困難**。」

Practice 15

> “She is incredibly patient.”

「她**極有耐性**。」

incredibly = 用來加強形容詞 / 副詞，表示程度非常高

8. **incredibly + positive adjective (非常.....) — 極其；令人驚嘆地**

Practice 16

> “The food was **incredibly good**.”

「食物**好得驚人 / 非常好吃**。」

Practice 17

> “She was incredibly kind.”

「她**非常善良**。」

incredibly = 強烈程度副詞，可加強正面評價

9. **incredibly + negative adjective (非常.....) — 極度；非常**

The adverb is not limited to positive things.

Practice 18

> “The journey was **incredibly tiring**.”

「旅程**非常令人疲倦**。」

Practice 19

> “The room was **incredibly noisy**.”

「房間**吵得不得了 / 非常吵**。」

incredibly = 只表示程度很高，本身不一定正面

10. **incredibly** = in a surprising way (令人驚訝地) — 出奇地；意外地

A closely related adverb use.

Practice 20

> “**Incredibly**, nobody was injured.”

「**令人難以置信的是**，竟然沒有人受傷。」

Practice 21

> “**Incredibly**, she finished the task in ten minutes.”

「**令人驚訝的是**，她十分鐘便完成了任務。」

incredibly = 句子副詞，表示整件事情令人非常驚訝 / 難以相信

This differs from:

> **incredibly strong**

where it simply intensifies an adjective.

11. **absolutely incredible** (非常驚人) — 簡直難以置信；極其出色

A common emphatic collocation.

Practice 22

> “The final performance was **absolutely incredible**.”

「最後的演出**簡直精彩得難以置信**。」

Practice 23

> “What she achieved was absolutely incredible.”

「她所取得的成就**簡直令人難以置信**。」

absolutely incredible = 對驚訝 / 讚賞作非常強烈的強調

12. **almost incredible** (幾乎令人難以置信) — 幾乎不敢相信

Practice 24

> “The speed of the change was **almost incredible**.”

「變化的速度**快得幾乎令人難以置信**。」

Practice 25

> “His recovery was almost incredible.”

「他的康復情況**幾乎令人不敢相信**。」

almost incredible = 非常驚人，以致接近難以相信

13. **incredibility** (難以置信) — 不可信程度；難以相信

A related noun, though less common in everyday English.

Practice 26

> “The **incredibility** of the claim made people suspicious.”

「這個說法的**難以置信程度**令人起疑。」

Practice 27

> “He pointed out the incredibility of the story.”

「他指出這個故事**令人難以相信之處**。」

incredibility = 某事令人難以相信 / 缺乏可信性的性質

Lower frequency than:

> unbelievable nature

> implausibility

in many contexts.

14. **incredulous = unable/unwilling to believe (不相信的 ; 懷疑的) — 難以置信的反應**

A very important related word.

Meaning: Showing that you find something difficult to believe.

Practice 28

> “She gave me an **incredulous look**.”

「她用**難以置信的眼神**看著我。」

Practice 29

> “He was incredulous when he heard the news.”

「他聽到消息時**簡直不敢相信**。」

incredulous = 對所聽 / 所見的事情表示難以相信

Important:

> **incredible** describes the thing.

> **incredulous** describes the person/reaction.

15. **incredulous look/expression (難以置信的表情) — 不敢相信的**

Practice 30

> “His face showed an **incredulous expression**.”

「他的臉上露出**難以置信的表情**。」

Practice 31

> “She raised her eyebrows in an incredulous look.”

「她揚起眉毛，露出一副**不敢相信的神情**。」

incredulous = 顯示某人不相信 / 很難接受某件事是真的

16. **incredulously** (難以置信地) — 不敢相信地

A related adverb.

Practice 32

> “‘You did what?’ she asked **incredulously**.”

「『你做了甚麼？』她**難以置信地**問。」

Practice 33

> “He stared at me **incredulously**.”

「他**不敢相信地**盯著我。」

incredulously = 以顯示難以相信的方式說話 / 看人

Important distinction: **incredible vs unbelievable**

These are very close.

incredible

originally:

> difficult to believe.

unbelievable

also:

> difficult to believe.

Both can also informally mean:

> extremely impressive/amazing.

Compare:

> “an incredible story”

> “an unbelievable story”

Both may mean:

> a story that is hard to believe.

But tone/context decides whether the speaker means:

> amazing

or:

> implausible.

Important distinction: **incredible vs amazing**

amazing

= causes great surprise or admiration.

incredible

can mean:

1. difficult to believe;
2. amazingly impressive.

So:

> incredible

has more ambiguity.

> amazing

does not normally imply literal lack of credibility as strongly.

Important distinction: ****incredible vs impressive****

****impressive****

= causes admiration because of quality, skill, size, etc.

****incredible****

= much stronger and more emotional/informal.

> “an impressive performance”

= 很出色的表演

> “an incredible performance”

= 精彩得令人驚嘆的表演

Important distinction: ****incredible vs extraordinary****

****extraordinary****

= very unusual / remarkable.

****incredible****

= difficult to believe or extremely amazing.

****Extraordinary**** is often more formal and less conversationally exaggerated.

Important distinction: ****incredible vs impossible****

These are not the same.

****incredible****

= difficult to believe.

****impossible****

= cannot happen/be done.

Something can sound incredible and still be completely true.

Important distinction: ****incredible vs implausible****

****incredible****

can be positive or negative.

****implausible****

specifically means:

> unlikely to be true/believable.

If your meaning is:

> “This explanation probably isn’t true,”

****implausible**** is more precise than enthusiastic modern ****incredible****.

Important distinction: ****incredible = unbelievable vs incredible = excellent****

Compare:

> “His excuse was incredible.”

This could mean:

> 他的藉口令人難以置信。

Potentially negative/skeptical.

But:

> “The concert was incredible.”

usually means:

> 演唱會非常精彩。

Context is essential.

Important distinction: **incredibly** = extremely vs **incredibly** = surprisingly

Compare:

> “She is **incredibly** patient.”

= 她非常有耐性。

Here it is an intensifier.

But:

> “**Incredibly**, she remained calm.”

= 令人驚訝的是，她保持冷靜。

Here it comments on the whole sentence.

Different grammatical function.

Important distinction: **incredibly** vs **very**

very

= neutral general intensifier.

incredibly

= much stronger and often conveys surprise/admiration.

> very strong

= 很強

> incredibly strong

= 強得驚人 / 極其強大

So your passage's:

> ****incredibly strong spirit****

is more emotionally emphatic than:

> ****very strong spirit****.

Important distinction: ****incredibly vs extremely****

These often overlap.

****extremely****

= very high degree, relatively neutral/formal.

****incredibly****

= very high degree with a stronger undertone of surprise or emphasis.

> extremely difficult

formal/neutral.

> incredibly difficult

more expressive.

Important distinction: ****incredible vs incredulous****

This is the biggest family trap.

****incredible****

describes the thing:

> “The story is incredible.”

= 故事令人難以置信 / 非常驚人。

incredulous

describes the person/reaction:

> “She was incredulous.”

= 她不敢相信。

So:

> ❌ “I am incredible” if you mean “I don’t believe it.”

That would mean:

> 我很不可思議 / 我非常厲害

depending on context.

Use:

> ✅ “I’m incredulous.”

though in everyday speech:

> “I can’t believe it.”

is more natural.

Important distinction: **incredulous vs skeptical**

incredulous

= immediate reaction of disbelief.

skeptical

= doubtful and wanting stronger evidence.

You can be skeptical calmly.

****Incredulous**** often sounds more surprised.

Important distinction: ****incredibility vs incredulity****

These are related but different.

****incredibility****

= quality of being difficult to believe.

****incredulity****

= a person's state/reaction of disbelief.

So:

> story → incredibility

> listener → incredulity

For general learners, ****incredulity**** is useful mainly for recognition.

17. ****incredulity (難以置信 / 懷疑) — 不信 ; 驚疑****

A useful advanced family noun.

Practice 34

> “She stared at him in ****incredulity****.”

「她****難以置信地****看著他。」

Practice 35

> “The announcement was met with incredulity.”

「這項宣布引來一片****難以置信 / 質疑****。」

****incredulity = 因某件事太難相信而產生的不信 / 驚訝反應****

Important distinction: ****incredibility vs incredulity****

****incredibility****

= the thing is hard to believe.

****incredulity****

= the person has difficulty believing it.

This mirrors:

> incredible ↔ incredulous.

Family-extension sweep

The practical ****incredible**** family is compact but has one very important semantic split:

* ****incredible — hard to believe**** = 難以置信的

* ****incredible — amazing/impressive**** = 驚人的 / 極為出色的

* ****incredible amount/degree**** = 驚人的數量 / 程度

* ****incredibly — extremely**** = 極其 / 非常

* ****incredibly — surprisingly**** = 令人驚訝地 / 難以置信地

* ****absolutely incredible**** = 簡直驚人 / 令人難以置信

* ****almost incredible**** = 幾乎令人不敢相信

* ****incredibility**** = 難以置信性 / 可信度低的性質

* ****incredulous**** = 表示難以相信的

* ****incredulous look**** = 難以置信的眼神

* ****incredulously**** = 難以置信地

* ****incredulity**** = 不信 / 驚疑

The main semantic branches are:

> ****difficult to believe****

and:

> ****extremely impressive / amazing****

while ****incredibly**** develops into:

> ****a strong degree intensifier = extremely****

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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incredible — hard to believe	某件事極不尋常、極不可能或極令人驚訝，因此很難相信
incredible — amazing	某人 / 某事出色、漂亮、厲害或驚人到令人非常讚嘆
incredible amount/degree	數量、規模或程度大得異乎尋常
incredibly — degree	用來加強形容詞 / 副詞，表示程度極高；非常 / 極其
incredibly — sentence adverb	表示整件事情令人難以相信 / 非常驚訝
incredibility	某項說法 / 事情令人難以相信的性質
incredulous	某人因覺得事情太難相信而表現出不信 / 驚訝
incredulously	以難以相信、驚疑的方式反應 / 說話
incredulity	因事情難以相信而產生的不信 / 驚疑狀態

For your original passage

> “Although she is quite small and physically frail, she has an ****incredibly strong spirit****.”

The exact meaning is:

****incredibly = extremely / remarkably****

Therefore:

> ****incredibly strong spirit****

= ****「極其堅強的精神 / 強大得令人佩服的內在力量」****

This creates a strong contrast:

> physically frail

but:

> incredibly strong in spirit.

The sentence is not questioning whether her inner strength is believable.

Instead, ****incredibly**** works as an expressive intensifier:

> strong

> → very strong

> → incredibly strong.

The most important learner contrasts are:

> ****an incredible story****

> = 難以置信的故事

> ****an incredible performance****

> = 驚人的 / 非常精彩的表演

> ****an incredible amount of work****

> = 驚人的工作量

> ****incredibly strong****

> = 極其強大 / 非常堅強

> ****incredibly difficult****

> = 極度困難

> ****Incredibly, nobody was hurt.****

> = 令人難以置信的是，竟然沒有人受傷

> ****an incredulous look****

> = 難以置信的眼神

> ****stare incredulously****

> = 難以置信地盯著看

So the key family map is:

****INCREDIBLE****

→ hard to believe

→ by extension, amazingly impressive

****INCREDIBLY****

→ in a way that is hard to believe

→ very commonly, simply “extremely”

****INCREDULOUS****

→ describes the person who does not believe

And in your passage:

****incredibly = “extremely / remarkably — her inner strength is exceptionally strong.”****